Emitting a Private Plan

docs.wetransact.io/emitting-a-private-plan

A private plan is a hidden pricing plan inside a Microsoft Marketplace offer that only the customers you nominate can see. You target those customers by their Microsoft Entra tenant ID, and they discover and buy the plan through the marketplace exactly like any other purchase — but at the price and configuration you set for them.

Use it when you want to give one specific customer special pricing without changing your public listing.

Note: A private plan is not the same as a private offer. A private plan lives inside your offer and is targeted by tenant ID. A private offer is a separate, negotiated deal targeted by billing account ID, with far more deal-making capability. See Private plan vs private offer below.

🟣 When to use a private plan

Choose a private plan when:

- A named customer has negotiated pricing that shouldn't be public.
- One customer needs a different configuration (term length, quantity tiers, metered dimensions).
- You're running a paid pilot or POC at a reduced rate.
- The customer wants the purchase to draw down their MACC (Microsoft Azure Consumption Commitment).
- The deal is direct — no reseller or channel partner in the middle.

Choose a **private offer** instead when the deal needs custom contract terms, multiple plans bundled together, a reseller, or a scheduled price change.

🟣 Key characteristics

Aspect	Detail
Targeting	Microsoft Entra tenant ID for SaaS offers. Azure subscription ID for Azure Application and Managed Service offers. Tenant ID, subscription ID, or both for Virtual Machine offers.
Audience size	Add up to 10 IDs manually, or import a CSV for more.
Plans per offer	Up to 45 private plans per offer.
Discovery	The customer finds the plan in the Azure portal or Microsoft Marketplace, under private plans (lock icon / "You have private products available" banner).
Pricing	Custom pricing and custom plan configuration.
MACC	Eligible, provided the offer is Azure benefit–eligible and the purchase is completed through the Azure portal during an active MACC term.
Time to appear	Up to 48 hours after you publish.
Roles needed to buy	Subscription Owner or Contributor. Billing account roles are *not* required.
Not supported	CSP subscriptions, multiparty / channel selling, custom PDF contract terms.

🟣 How it works

1. **You collect the customer's tenant ID.** They find it in Microsoft Marketplace under their profile icon → **View tenant**, or in the Azure portal under Microsoft Entra ID.
2. **You create the plan** inside your existing offer and set its pricing and configuration.
3. **You set the plan's availability to private** and add the customer's tenant ID to the audience.
4. **You publish the offer.** The plan goes through Microsoft's review and publishing flow.
5. **The plan becomes visible to that customer** — allow up to 48 hours.
6. **The customer signs in and purchases** from the private plans area, using a subscription they own or contribute to.
7. **Billing and payout follow the normal marketplace flow** — Microsoft invoices the customer, and the sale appears in your payout report like any other transaction.

🟣 How to publish a private plan

Before you start

- The offer must already exist and be live (or in draft and ready to publish).
- You need the customer's **tenant ID** — confirm it in writing; a wrong ID is the most common cause of "the customer can't see the plan".
- Confirm the customer is **not** on a CSP-managed subscription (see Limitations).

🟣 Steps

1. Open the offer in the **WeTransact portal** and go to product Listing.

2. Go to Plan & pricing section and Select Add pricing— or clone an existing plan if the new one is a variation of your public pricing.
3. Give the plan an internal-friendly name (for example, Contoso – Enterprise Annual). The customer sees this name, so keep it professional.
4. Add the customer's **tenant ID** to the private audienc. Add your tenant ID as well for the best practice to see the private plan if its live.
5. Set **pricing and billing terms**: price, billing cadence, per-user limits and any metered dimensions.
6. Save, then **publish the offer**.
7. Once live, tell the customer it can take up to 48 hours to appear, and send them the how to purchase steps below.

Video: https://www.loom.com/embed/177fa9d496de45ff9294542e84024e1c
Tip: Name and document every private plan against the deal it belongs to. With up to 45 private plans allowed per offer, an unlabelled list becomes unmanageable quickly.

🟣 Updating the audience later

You can add or remove customers from an existing private plan using **Sync Private Audiences** – this takes effect without re-certifying or fully republishing the offer. Pricing changes, by contrast, require a normal republish.

🟣 Limitations and things to watch

- **CSP is not supported.** Customers on subscriptions established through a CSP reseller cannot buy a private plan. Workarounds: send a CSP private offer with a reseller margin, have the CSP grant the customer rights to buy the public plan, or have the customer set up a separate MCA billing account (the only option of the three that preserves MACC decrement).
- **No multiparty or channel selling.** Private plans are direct-to-customer only.
- **Limited deal-making.** No custom PDF contract terms, no bundling multiple plans into one deal, no scheduled future price changes – those are private offer capabilities.
- **Not available for** Virtual Machine Software Reservations (VMSR), professional services, consulting services, "Contact me" listings, or free services.
- **An offer that contains only private plans is not visible in Microsoft Marketplace** – it can only be reached by its targeted audience.
- **VM offers:** private plan names, IDs and URNs stay publicly visible via Azure CLI (for example az vm image list). Only deployment is restricted, so avoid putting the customer's name in the plan name for VM offers.
- **Plan visibility is not freely reversible.** Plan an offer's public/private structure up front rather than flipping an existing plan's visibility. [TO CONFIRM – check current Partner Center behaviour before publishing]

🟣 Private plan vs private offer

	Private plan	Private offer (direct)
Targeted by	Microsoft Entra tenant ID	Billing account ID
Where it lives	Inside your existing offer	A separate private offer
Time until purchasable	Up to 48 hours	~15 minutes
Customer steps	Purchase directly	Accept, then purchase (two separate steps)
Roles needed	Subscription Owner / Contributor	Billing account Owner / Contributor to accept, plus Subscription Owner / Contributor to purchase
Pricing control	Any custom plan price and configuration	Percentage discount, absolute price, or a new plan
Plans per deal	One	Up to 10 bundled
Custom PDF contract terms	No	Yes
CSP / multiparty	Not supported	CSP private offers and multiparty private offers available
MACC	Yes, if the offer is Azure benefit–eligible	Yes, if the offer is Azure benefit–eligible
Best for	Simple custom pricing for a known tenant	Negotiated deals, channel deals, custom terms

🟣 Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Customer can't see the plan after 48 hours	Wrong or mistyped tenant ID	Ask the customer to re-confirm via **profile icon → View tenant**, then correct the audience with Sync Private Audiences
Customer sees the plan but can't complete purchase	They're using a subscription outside the private audience, or lack Owner/Contributor rights	Have them switch subscription at checkout, or get the right role assigned
Customer on CSP can't see or buy anything	CSP subscriptions can't accept private plans	Use a CSP private offer, or a separate MCA billing account
Purchase didn't draw down MACC	Offer isn't Azure benefit–eligible, or the purchase wasn't completed in the Azure portal	Enrol the offer in the Azure benefit, then have the customer purchase again through the Azure portal
Plan appeared, but at the wrong price	Pricing change published without a full republish	Republish the offer; only audience changes are instant via Sync Private Audiences

🟣 FAQs

How many private plans can one offer have?

Up to 45.

Can I add more customers to a private plan after publishing?

Yes — use Sync Private Audiences. No recertification needed.

Does a private plan purchase count toward the customer's MACC?

Yes, when the offer is Azure benefit–eligible, the purchase is made through the Azure portal, and the customer's MACC term is active. 100% of the pretax amount is applied when Microsoft invoices.

Can a CSP customer buy a private plan?

No. Use a CSP private offer, or have the customer purchase through a separate MCA billing account if MACC drawdown matters.

What's the marketplace fee on a private plan?

The standard marketplace fee applies (3% on most transactable offers). The reduced renewal rate is a private offer mechanism, not a private plan one.

Can I hide the plan from everyone except one customer, but keep my offer public?

Yes — that's the standard setup. Public plans stay visible to everyone; the private plan is visible only to the targeted tenants.

💬 ***For more, contact us at : support@wetransact.io***

Always-current version of this guide: docs.wetransact.io/emitting-a-private-plan · Questions? Reply to this email and your CSM will pick it up.